

User Personas

Three representative users of Gem Finder

Sarah Lin

28 · Tourist from Chicago

Primary User

Background

First-time Manhattan visitor on a 2-day solo trip. Uses TripAdvisor and Instagram to plan, but gets overwhelmed by crowds. Light packer.

Goals

See iconic Manhattan spots without wasting time in lines

Discover less-touristy experiences at the right time

Frustrations

High-rated spots always crowded when she visits

No easy way to know crowd levels in advance

Quote

"I'd rather leisurely visit three nice places than rush through ten crowded ones."

David & Maria

63 / 61 · Retired couple from Florida

Accessibility User

Background

Maria uses a wheelchair. They visit NYC once a year. Always anxious about accessibility at new places. Plan carefully in advance but rely on outdated or inconsistent info sources.

Goals

Confirm wheelchair access before making any trip

Find less crowded times — crowds make wheelchair passthrough harder

Frustrations

Accessibility info online is inconsistent and untrustworthy

Crowds significantly worsen the wheelchair experience

Quote

"We just want to know before we leave the hotel — is it accessible and will it be manageable?"

Kevin J.

35 · NYC Local exploring own city

Secondary User

Background

NYC resident for 8 years who wants to show visiting friends around without the tourist trap experience. Knows Manhattan well but wants data-backed timing suggestions to optimize random weekend plans.

Goals

Show visiting friends "his NYC" — quality experiences over checking off tourist boxes
Track his own Manhattan exploration — log check-ins at spots he's never visited before

Frustrations

Existing apps treat him like a first-time tourist — general top-10 lists with no timing intelligence
Feels embarrassed when he takes friends somewhere that turns out to be overcrowded or closed

QUOTE

"I've lived here for eight years and I still have to search 'best time to visit the High Line' like a tourist. I just want an app that tells me: go now, it's quiet."